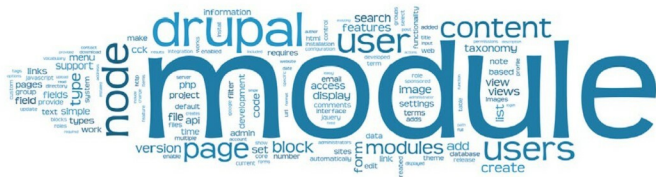


What Makes Drupal Your Preferred Choice?

Drupal, an open source Content Management System (CMS), would certainly appeal to a Do-It-Yourself (DIY) enthusiast. It enables users to get a website up and running within minutes and needs no technical knowledge. DIY notwithstanding, Drupal is also used by the White House, by newspapers and several commercial entities. Read on to learn more about the salient features of Drupal.



The origin of the Internet can be traced to the early 1990s. During this period, websites were predominantly text-based. In the mid-1990s, pages included columns and frames that made it possible for a site to have a navigation bar. The use of background images was possible and considered a very advanced design principle. The mid-1990s also saw the use of page 'Hit counters' and marquee text. Online page builders like Geocities that allowed people to put up their own sites were very popular during this period. Though Macromedia introduced Flash, it hadn't gained widespread acceptance amongst people. It was only in the late 1990s that Flash began to grow in popularity and designers started inserting Flash elements into pages to add some punch to their sites. It was during this period that Rasmus Lerdorf released PHP. Incidentally, in April 1999, he spoke at the BangLinux event in Bengaluru.

The early 2000s saw the rise of CSS and JavaScript. These technologies made it possible for designers and developers to separate the design elements from the content. They also allowed designers to animate the pages by, for example, adding a drop down menu. HTML forms began to make their appearance. This is what 'The Hindu' website (<http://www.hindu.com/thehindu/2000/01/01/>) looked like during that time. The mid-2000s saw the 'semantic Web' movement, during which there were attempts to make machines understand human requests before satisfying them. The late 2000s saw the emergence of Web 2.0 with extensive usage of AJAX for content transition, an increase in page payloads due to increased usage of High Definition images, and the emergence of social networking sites like Facebook, Twitter, etc. This period also saw the emergence of mobile devices and tablets with different screen sizes and resolutions, and it became necessary to design

the page for multiple devices. So pages became lengthier rather than wider and design elements became flatter. The convergence of these technologies required a framework that could manage different types of content and deliver them to different devices, often with different screen sizes and resolutions.

What is a CMS and why you should choose Drupal

A CMS is an application that allows the creation, editing and publishing of content from a single interface so that it can be viewed by people with different devices. Content can be digital assets like text pages, images, audio/video clips, comments, forum posts, etc. There are several CMSs that allow you to create and publish content on the Web, and of them, Drupal is one of the world's most popular.

Drupal provides several out-of-the-box functionalities for Web developers and designers. Using these features, you can assemble a site in a few minutes. Designers will love the separation of the presentation layer from the content. Drupal achieves this using a template mechanism that allows designers to dictate how the content should be rendered in browsers. Drupal's support for external libraries allows designers to create responsive websites. On the deployment front, Drupal has the ability to scale up to handle several thousands of users.

For content writers, Drupal provides several tools that allow authoring and publication of content. These are not amateur tools but are powerful enough to support content-rich sites like those of newspapers. It also has robust user management features, revision control, a rich taxonomy and several other features that are a content writer's dream.

Though Drupal offers several out-of-the-box functionalities, there may be instances where a Web developer feels that it falls